

Annual Leave Policy

Category: Leave | Effective: January 2025 | Version 1.0

The Annual Leave Policy establishes the framework for annual leave entitlements, procedures, and responsibilities, ensuring compliance with Lebanese Labour Law while balancing employee well-being and operational continuity. This policy applies to all full-time employees of inmind.ai who have completed the required period of continuous service.

Annual Leave Entitlement

Employees are entitled to a minimum of 15 working days of paid annual leave upon completing one year of uninterrupted service, as stipulated by Lebanese Labour Law. For employees who have not yet completed one year of service, annual leave entitlement will be calculated on a pro-rata basis, with leave accrued at the rate of 1.25 days per month worked. Leave is calculated based on the calendar year, starting January 1st and ending December 31st. Part-time employees and contractual workers are not eligible for annual leave under this policy unless explicitly stated in their employment contracts.

Procedures for Requesting Leave

- Submission of Leave Requests:** Employees must submit a written leave request through the company's designated HR management system or via email to their direct supervisor. The request must specify the intended dates of leave and should be submitted at least two (2) weeks in advance.
- Approval Process:** The direct supervisor will review the leave request, taking into account operational requirements, workload distribution, and team availability. Once reviewed, the supervisor will forward the request to the HR department for final approval.
- Notification of Approval/Decline:** Employees will receive written confirmation of their leave approval or a valid explanation for denial within five (5) working days of submitting their request.
- Documentation:** Approved leave requests will be documented in the employee's records to ensure accurate tracking of leave balances.

Scheduling and Usage of Leave

- Employees are encouraged to plan their leave in coordination with their team to minimize disruption to business operations.
- Leave may be taken in full or in increments of at least one (1) working day, unless otherwise approved by management.
- Employees are required to utilize their annual leave within the same calendar year. Unused leave days will be forfeited unless exceptional circumstances apply.

Carryover and Forfeiture of Leave

In alignment with company policy, unused leave days cannot be carried over to the following calendar year unless written approval is granted by management. Such approval will only be considered under exceptional circumstances, such as the employee being unable to take leave due to a critical business need or personal emergencies. Any carryover leave must be used within the first quarter (January 1 to March 31) of the subsequent year. Failure to do so will result in the forfeiture of unused leave days.

Exceptions to Policy

- Probationary Employees:** Employees on probation are not eligible to take annual leave. However, they will begin accruing leave from their start date, and the accrued balance will be available upon successful completion of the probationary period.
- Unforeseen Circumstances:** In cases of unforeseen personal emergencies, employees may request annual leave on short notice. Such requests will be reviewed on a case-by-case basis and are subject to approval by management.
- Overlapping Leave Requests:** If multiple employees within the same team submit overlapping leave requests, priority will be determined based on the order of submission, operational needs, and, where applicable, seniority.

Employee Responsibilities

Employees are responsible for:

- Planning and submitting leave requests in a timely manner.
- Ensuring that their duties are adequately delegated or completed before the start of their leave.
- Providing accurate and honest information regarding leave requests.
- Returning to work on the agreed-upon date and resuming duties promptly.

Employer Responsibilities

The company is committed to:

- Ensuring compliance with Lebanese Labour Law regarding annual leave entitlements.
- Reviewing and responding to leave requests within a reasonable timeframe.
- Balancing employee well-being with business operational needs.
- Providing a transparent and accessible system for tracking and managing leave balances.

Compliance and Disciplinary Measures

Employees are required to adhere strictly to the procedures and guidelines outlined in this policy. Abuse of leave privileges, such as submitting fraudulent leave requests or failing to return to work as scheduled, will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment, as per the company's disciplinary policy.

Compliance with Lebanese Labour Law

This policy has been developed in accordance with the provisions of Lebanese Labour Law, which mandates a minimum of 15 days of annual leave for employees who have completed one year of service. Any updates to relevant legislation will be incorporated into this policy to ensure continued compliance.

Review and Amendments

This policy will be reviewed annually by the HR department to ensure alignment with legal requirements and organizational needs. Any amendments will be communicated to all employees in a timely manner.

By adhering to this policy, inmind.ai aims to foster a balanced workplace environment where employees are encouraged to take time off to recharge, while ensuring that business continuity is maintained.